IT is hereby notified that the Minister of Energy and Power Development, after consultation with the Zimbabwe Energy Regulatory Authority, in terms of section 65 of the Electricity Act [*Chapter 13:19*], has made the following regulations:—

1. These regulations may be cited as the Electricity (Public Safety) (Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (No. 1).

2. Section 2 of the Electricity (Public Safety) Regulations, 2018 published in Statutory Instrument 177 of 2018 (hereinafter called the "principal regulations"), is amended by the repeal of the following definitions and substitution of the following—

""electrical artisan or electrician" means any person who is certified by the Industrial Trade Testing Department to undertake electrical work articulated in terms of section 3 and the First Schedule;

"electrical or mechanical or renewable energy engineer" means any person holding such university or college degree or other qualification and having such relevant experience as are recognised by the relevant constituent body for the purposes of the engineering discipline or disciplines of which he or she is a practitioner;

"electricity infrastructure" means equipment and apparatus used in the generation, transmission, distribution, and consumption of electricity from a minimum of 220Volts;

"electrically unsafe" in relation to works, installations, fittings, appliances, and associated equipment, presence of a risk that a person or animal may suffer serious harm, or that property may suffer significant damage, as a result of dangers arising from the use of, or passage of electricity through, the works, installations, fittings, appliances, or associated equipment;

"electrical works" refers to the act of supervising, carrying out or conducting of any of the following activities on electricity infrastructure—

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(a) constructing, manufacturing, or assembling;

(b) installing or connecting;

(c) testing, certifying, or inspecting;

(d) maintaining or repairing, excluding works specified in the Fifth Schedule provided a competent electrical artisan or a linesman is supervising;

"electrical repairs" means the work done to fix an electrical system that is malfunctioning excluding replacement of broken socket or miniature circuit breaker or lighting fixtures or light switches;

"designated responsible official" means a person contracted by or in the employment of the licensee or electricity undertaking tasked to oversee the construction, maintenance, and or operation of a piece of infrastructure;

"installation" means an electrical system that generates, transmits and distributes electricity;

"illegal connection" means a connection or extension to any electricity infrastructure through which electricity services are provided but not authorised by the licensee;

"licensee inspector" means a person appointed by the licensee to carry out inspections;

"senior authorised person" means a competent person trained and authorised by the primary transmission or primary distribution licensee to carry out work and all forms of switching on the licensee's power system in accordance with his or her certificate of authorisation.".

3. Section 3 of the principal regulations is amended—

(a) by the repeal of subsection (3)(a) and the substitution of—

"(a) a holder of a minimum Class IV Electrician Journeyman or Apprenticeship certificate issued by the National Apprentice Board of Zimbabwe under the Manpower Planning and Development Act [*Chapter 28:021*] as specified in the First Schedule;";

(b) by the repeal of subsection (4) (a) and (d) (i) and (iv) and substitution of—

"(a) all completed electrical works, installation, appliance fittings, or any part of such works or installation are electrically safe;

"(d) he or she complies with—

(i) electricity undertaking or service provider's instructions for the electrical safety of persons and property or the 1998 ZESA Electrical Safety Rules and any subsequent amendments in the absence of the standing electrical safety 1208 instructions; and

(iv) licensee or undertaking-approved standards, codes, engineering and safety standards or instructions governing the works as per the requirement of section 58 of the Act.";

(c) by the insertion of a new subsection after subsection (4) as follows—

"(4a) Any person who designs electrical installations shall ensure that the end product is electrically safe.";

(d) by the repeal of subsection (5) and substitution of—

"(5) Switching operations must be in accordance with the 1998 ZESA Electrical Safety Rules.";

(e) by the repeal of subsection (7) and the substitution of—

"(7) the designated responsible official of electrical works being undertaken must ensure that all work is carried out safely in accordance with the licensee's 1998 ZESA Electrical Safety Rules and subsequent amendments.

(7a) Every owner shall ensure that—

(a) all premises are fitted with residual current circuit breakers (RCCB) or Earth leakage circuit breakers (ELCB) corresponding to the supply capacity;

(b) RCCB or ELCB are installed within twelve months from the date of promulgation of these regulations for existing electricity connected premises and upon application for any new connection.

(7b) The RCCB or ELCB shall conform to Zimbabwe Standards ZWS400, or IEC 61008, IEC62423 or any equivalent standards and any subsequent changes.

(7c) The licensee shall disconnect supply of electricity for any premise that is not fitted with RCCB or ELCB or where the RCCB or ELCB has been tampered with.".

4. Section 4 of the principal regulations is amended by the repeal of subsections (1), (2), and (3) and substitution of the following—

"(1) No electrical works shall be carried out by any person except by a certified Journeyman.

(2) Works involving line construction, inspection, maintenance or repairs shall be carried out as specified in the Sixth Schedule and by a competent person with the minimum qualification of a Linesmen 1.

(3) No electricity undertaking, owner of property or consumers shall energise electrical installation work, including

additions, alterations, split-metering and repairs to existing installations, carried out on the premises of any electrical undertaking or consumer unless approved by the licensee.

(3a) Any person who owns or operates works, installations, fittings, or appliances must not use or allow any other person to use or work, on installations, fittings, or appliances if the installations, fittings, or appliances are electrically unsafe.

(3b) Any person who uses equipment for installation testing and repairs must ensure that the equipment used does not endanger persons or property.

(3c) The property owner or consumer must ensure that there are no illegal connections on the property at all times.".

5. The principal regulations are amended by the insertion of the following sections after section 14—

"*Safe electrical works, fittings, appliances and installation*

15. (1) Works and installations are deemed to be electrically safe if they are carried out in places that do at least one of the following—

(a) prevent accidental direct or indirect contact with exposed fittings or exposed conductive parts of the works or installations; or

(b) provide for the automatic disconnection of the power supply to the works or installations on the occurrence of a fault that would cause injury or damage to any person or property; or

(c) prevent an electric current passing through the body of a person on contact with any part of the works or installations, or limit that current so that the magnitude and duration of the electric shock does not exceed the IEC standards.

(2) Works and installations are also deemed to be electrically safe if—

(a) the equipment and materials used for works or installations have no defects; or

(b) standard electrical phase colour coding of equipment, conductors or cables is adhered to as follows—

(i) red for phase 1;

(ii) yellow for phase 2;

(iii) blue for phase 3;

(iv) black for neutral;

(v) where a single phase is used the phase shall be red or brown in colour and neutral shall be black, and the earth wire shall be green and yellow or bare; or

(c) spacing between bare conducting parts is adequate or the insulation thickness of the cable is within the acceptable standards; or

(d) there is sufficient space, access, and lighting to install, operate, maintain, repair, test, and inspect all fittings of the works and installations in a safe manner.

(3) A fitting or equipment is deemed to be electrically safe if—

(a) the unearthed conductive parts of the fitting or equipment are separated from live parts by minimum insulation; or

(b) it has a safety function.

(4) An appliance is deemed to be electrically safe if—

(a) the voltage at which it operates safely is appropriately and adequately marked on the appliance; or

(b) it is constructed to be safe under both normal and abnormal conditions; or

(c) the accessible unearthed conductive parts of the appliance are separated from live parts by minimum insulation; or

(d) it is fitted with a safety switch to interrupt overcurrent or overloading.

(5) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level 5 or

to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Supply of electricity to appliances and other handheld appliances

16. (1) Appliances and other handheld appliances shall be connected to—

(a) fused plug or a plug of corresponding current carrying capacity; or

(b) electricity supply cable of corresponding current carrying capacity as specified in the Seventh Schedule; or

(c) electricity supply cable with adequate insulation in terms of section 21 and in accordance with Zimbabwe Standards or equivalent standards.

(2) Electricity supply voltage to a handheld appliance must not exceed 240Vac measured to earth.

(3) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level five or to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Repurposing of electrical appliance or component

17. (1) Whenever an electrical appliance or component's use is changed to perform an alternative task, the following shall be obliged in its entirety—

(a) carried out by a competent person as provided for in terms of section 3;

(b) the appliance remains electrically safe;

(c) safety and protection mechanism of the appliance to remain intact and in operable condition;

(d) all hazards are to be eliminated.

(2) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level five or

to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Electrical accidents report and investigations

18. (1) Electrical accident investigation reports shall be submitted by the licensee or undertaking to the Authority within ten working days of occurrence in the form and manner specified in the Eighth Schedule.

(2) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level 5 or to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Electrical works assignment

19. (1) No licensee, undertaking or employer shall assign an employee or agent or contractor to work on electricity infrastructure unless the requirements of section 3 are met.

(2) No licensee, undertaking or employer in operation of a distribution network above and including 1000V shall operate it without a senior authorised person for the same voltage level or above.

(3) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level 5 or to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Inspection and approval of new electricity infrastructure and buildings

20. (1) The licensee shall ensure that all new electricity infrastructure installations carried out internally or by agents or contractor are inspected and approved.

(2) The records for such inspections and approvals shall be filed with the licensee for a period of at least five years.

(3) Licensee inspector or appointed agent or contractor, acting in good faith, shall at all reasonable times enter any premises where there is an electricity service connection for the purposes of inspection.

(4) No person shall hinder or obstructs a licensee inspector or appointed agent or contractor in the discharge of his or her lawful duties in terms of subsection (3).

(5) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level 5 or to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Electrical cables and conductors

21. (1) All electrical cables and conductors shall be in accordance with SAZS 240:1999 and SAZS 680:1999.

(2) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level 5 or to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Registration of certified electrical personnel and contractors

22. (1) The Authority shall register electrical certified personnel and maintain a register of all registered electrical certified personnel.

(2) The registration specified in subsection (1), shall be renewed every five years in accordance with the registration conditions specified by the Authority in consultation with relevant associations.

(3) The Authority shall publish a list of the registered electrical certified personnel, and the registration fee shall be as specified in the Ninth Schedule.

Completion of Works Certificate

23. (1) Upon completion of electrical works and after inspection by the licensee, a completion of works certificate set out in the Tenth Schedule shall be issued by the electrician and signed for by the client who shall keep a copy of the certificate as proof of works that have been carried out.

(2) The completion of work certificate shall be the basis of any subsequent inspection and repairs.

(3) Any person who contravenes this section shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding level 5 or to imprisonment for a period not exceeding six months or to both such fine and such imprisonment.".

6. The principal regulations are amended by the insertion of the following Schedules—

"FIFTH SCHEDULE (*Section 2*)

WORKS EXEMPTION

The following works are exempted from being part of what forms electrical works;

(a) wayleave clearing;

(b) substation ground weeding and clearing;

(c) substation civils maintenance and repairs;

(d) general clearing and any other such works that may be carried out around the electrical infrastructure.

SIXTH SCHEDULE (*Section 4* (*2*))

LINESMAN CLASSIFICATION

Linesman Class	Proficiency	Voltage Level
1	Construction and maintenance	Up to and including 11kV
2	Construction and maintenance	Up to and including 33kV
Certificate	Construction and maintenance	Up to and including 420kV

SEVENTH SCHEDULE (*Section 16*(*1*)(*b*))

ELECTRICAL CABLES CURRENT CARRYING CAPACITY

All values have a tolerance of ±5%

1. Power cables 3 Core and 4 Core 600/1000V

Cable Size (mm2)	**Current Ratings (A)**		
	Ground	**Ducts**	**Air**
1.5	23	18	18
2.5	30	24	24
4	38	31	32

Cable Size (mm2)	Current Ratings (A)		
	Ground	Ducts	Air
6	48	39	40
10	64	52	54
16	82	67	72
25	126	101	113
35	147	120	136
50	176	144	167
70	215	175	207
95	257	210	253
120	292	239	293
150	328	269	336
185	369	303	384
240	422	348	447
300	472	397	509

2. House wiring cable 600/1000V

Cable Size (mm2)	Nominal Stranding Number/Diameter (mm)	Current Rating* (A)
1	7/0.42	17
1.5	7/0.53	21
2.5	7/0.66	27
4	7/0.86	36
6	7/1.04	45
10	7/1.35	61
16	7/1.67	78
25	19/1,38	104
35	19/1.62	125
50	19/1.88	149
70	19/2.28	190
95	19/2.50	238
120	37/2.03	272
150	37/2.28	308
185	37/2.50	350

* Rating based on two touching cables installed in a duct, assumed ambient air temperature is 30°C, assumed maximum conductor temperature is 70°C.

3. Flexible cable

Cable Size (mm2)	Number of Cores	Current Rating* (A)	
		1Ø	3Ø
Light Duty 300/300V			
0.5	2	3	3
	3		
	4		
	5		
0.75	3	6	6
Normal Duty 300/500V			
0.75	2	6	6
	3		
	4		
	5		
	7		
1	2	10	10
	3		
	4		
	5		
	7		
1.5	2	16	16
	3		
	4		
	5		
	7		
2.5	2	25	20
	3		
	4		
	5		
	7		
4	2	32	25
	3		
	4		
	5		

* Assumed ambient air temperature is 30°C, assumed maximum conductor temperature is 70°C.

EIGHTH SCHEDULE (*Section 18(1)*)

ELECTRICAL ACCIDENT NOTIFICATION AND REPORTS

1. Notification template

(a) current date;

(b) ZETDC region;

(c) fatal/non-fatal accident;

(d) member involved—staff or public;

(e) date and time of accident;

(f) date and time that the report of the accident was received;

(g) name of victim;

(h) date of birth of victim or age;

(i) gender of victim;

(j) contact number of victim or relative of victim;

(k) location of accident, giving the region, town or city or location, address;

(l) voltage level involved;

(m) brief circumstances of the accident.

2. Report template

(a) date and time of accident;

(b) date and time that the report of the accident was received and from whom (name);

(c) date and time that the accident was reported to the police and by whom (name) i.e. consumer or company;

(d) fatal/non-fatal accident;

(e) details of victim involved – name, date of birth (age) and gender;

(f) address or place of residence of the victim;

(g) location of accident, giving the region, town or city or location, address, line section number, and preferable portions of the geographical and diagrammatic layout suitably marked up and the GPS coordinates in decimal degrees;

(h) voltage level involves;

(i) in the case of persons injured in the course of their employment, the name and address of the employer and E.C. Number;

(j) nature of injuries and in the case of death, postmortem result;

(k) written statements by undertaking or consumer's staff involved;

(l) risk assessment carried out on the nature work which was being done;

(m) safety preparation and inspection of tools which were being used;

(n) task evaluation or review hierarchy;

(o) statements by direct and indirect witnesses;

(p) photographs of the victim, site and any other scenes which will have a contribution to the report;

(q) sketch drawing of the accident site, if subparagraph (j) does not fully capture this;

(r) operation of relevant protective devices, if any (include reasons for not tripping if it did not);

(s) the circumstances of the accident and name of employee who visited the site of accident;

(t) all relevant details of the site of the accident e.g. the height and position of conductors, ground clearance, earth resistance, danger notices, proximity to foot paths or roads, or any other item having a bearing on the accident;

(u) attach the installation inspector's report on consumer installation;

(v) details of the contracted installer if available;

(w) any other information considered necessary;

(x) causes of the accident; direct, contributory, root or underlying and remote causes;

(y) liability for the accident;

(z) steps taken in the short term and being taken in the long-term period to avoid future recurrence;

(aa) indication of disciplinary action being taken in the case of violation of safety rules;

(bb) place and date of the latest electricity safety awareness campaign.

NINTH SCHEDULE (*Section 22(3)*)

REGISTRATION FEES FOR CERTIFIED ELECTRCIAL PERSONNEL AND LINESMAN

1. Electrical artisan or electrician

Journeymen Class	**Fee**	**Period**
4	USD15,00	5 years
3	USD20,00	
2	USD30,00	
1	USD40,00	

2. Linesman

Linesman Class	**Fee**	**Period**
1	USD15,00	5years
2	USD15,00	
Certificate	USD15,00	

TENTH SCHEDULE (*Section 23(1)*)

COMPLETION OF WORKS CERTIFICATE

To:

The Premise Owner,

I,……..……(Name), being an qualified **Engineer/Electrician** Registration No._____hereby state that I have completed, assessed and reviewed the electrical works, being the …… …… …… …… ……..…… …… …… …… …… …… …… and have reviewed the electrical works documents, applicable standards, checklists, submitted along with progress of works in respect of the various elements of

the components of the project in the premises of *No*. _____ *Street Name:* _____ *Town/City:* _____ *Province:* _____ and certify that the requirements of Electricity (Public Safety) Regulations were complied with.

I further certify that all reasonable professional skill, care, and diligence have been taken in verifying the project documents and scope of electrical work in respect of the various elements of the components covered in project, and contents thereof are a true representation of the facts and meet the requirements of Regulations.

Signature: _____

Name of Engineer/Electrician: _____Registration

No: _____

Date: _____.".